

## **Project 2: Mapping an Experience**

Anya Krishnamony, Abby Miu, Maya Hong, Viraj Aggarwal

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# Brainstorming, Research & Observations

## Observing Curry

- Focused on 3 different areas: food court, upper floor, and outside (Snell Library Quad)

### Location 1: Food Court

- Actions: Mostly working on assignments or just chatting and eating
- Conversations/Relationships: People sitting with friends, suitemates, teammates for group projects, or by themselves
- Moods: Excited, calm, happy, busy, studious, lonely

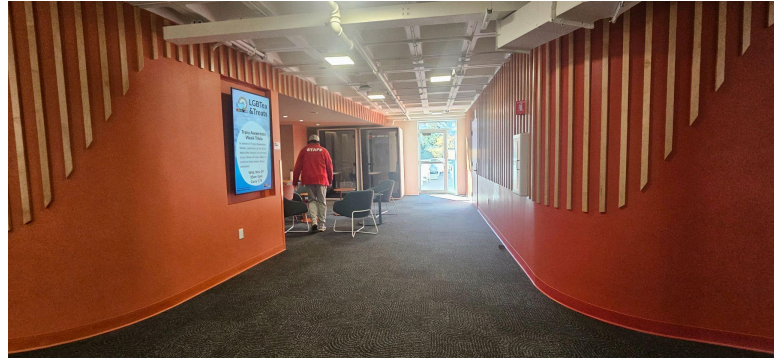
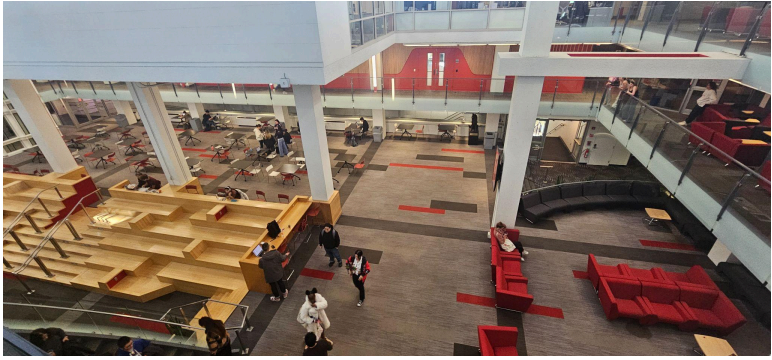
### Location 2: Upper Floor

- Actions: People on phones, doing work, on laptops messaging, on facetime, eating, working on presentations, classrooms full of students learning something, group of students holding flowers (maybe celebrating something), walking and listening to music with coffees in hand, rushing to get to a certain place
- Conversations/Relationships: Most conversations are between roommates and suitemates
- Moods: Happy/cheerful vibe, studious (quiet and focused on work), busy, chill/casual

### Location 3: Outside Curry (Snell Library Quad)

- Actions: Exclusively walking (not many people sitting around), either by themselves or alone, around 60-70% with headphones in (but not all listening to music, some on calls)
- Conversations/Relationships: No more than 3 people walking together, very engaged in their conversations
- Moods: Distracted, energetic (walking with determination to get somewhere), calm/peaceful, tired, productive

## Photos



## **Mapping Brainstorm**

### **Topic Ideas**

- Want to track movement: focusing on areas where walking is more prevalent
- How people walking in groups, pairs, individual affects identity
- Songs people listen to (by genre) and how they're feeling on two different/contrasting days- do certain songs influence emotion or does emotion influence songs picked?
- People with beverages in hand at different times of day - what types of beverages, temperature, colors, etc.
- Conversations had in a certain area

### **Mapping details**

- Colors representing emotion
- Simple sketches representing tasks
- Different fonts for different days of the week
- Different direction of lines for different days
- Mood (colors)
- Song/Genre (direction)

## **Final Topic: Mapping Music Genres and Feelings Across Contrasting Days**

### **Potential Questions**

- Do certain music genres correlate with certain emotional states?
- Is the emotional mood more affected by the music chosen or the environment and time of day?
- How do emotional expressions differ when students listen to music alone (with headphones) versus interacting with friends?

### **Data Collection Process**

- Ask people walking through the area two things:
  - What song they are currently listening to
  - How does it makes them feel
- Focus on two days/timeframes: Friday afternoon/evening (Halloween) and Sunday morning
- Classify songs by set genre groups and emotion groups
- Map locations where students gather and listen to specific genres and feelings

### **Goals**

- To create an unconventional map that reveals the emotional and musical setting of the quad



- Depict how music and mood are represented in everyday life, especially with students
- To see how different environments and timing influence what we listen to and our emotions

## Data Collection - Songs & Emotions

Friday October 31, 2025

4:00 PM - 4:15 PM

Cloudy, 40\*

| Name of Song + Artist                  | Genre                  | Emotion/Feeling |
|----------------------------------------|------------------------|-----------------|
| I Put A Spell On You<br>- Annie Lennox | Rock                   | Powerful        |
| CLOVER - Cannelle                      | Indie / Alternative    | Happy           |
| Follow God - Kanye West                | Hip-Hop / R&B          | Energetic       |
| Stateside - PinkPantheress             | Hip-Hop / R&B          | Energetic       |
| Bloody Mary - Lady Gaga                | Pop / Alt Pop          | Powerful        |
| Message in a Bottle - Oscar blue       | Indie / Alternative    | Sad             |
| Santa - Rvssian                        | Global / International | Energetic       |
| White cat - Yves                       | K-Pop / Dance Pop      | Happy           |
| Mona Lisa - Dominic Fike               | Indie / Alternative    | Happy           |
| Mr Rager - Kid Cudi                    | Hip-Hop / R&B          | Energetic       |
| Mad About You - Hooverphonic           | Indie / Alternative    | Energetic       |
| R u ok? - ifeye                        | K-Pop / Dance Pop      | Energetic       |
| Circadian Rhythm - Drake               | Hip-Hop / R&B          | Happy           |
| Glory Pox - Portishead                 | Rock                   | Powerful        |
| Glitter - lexycat                      | Indie / Alternative    | Energetic       |

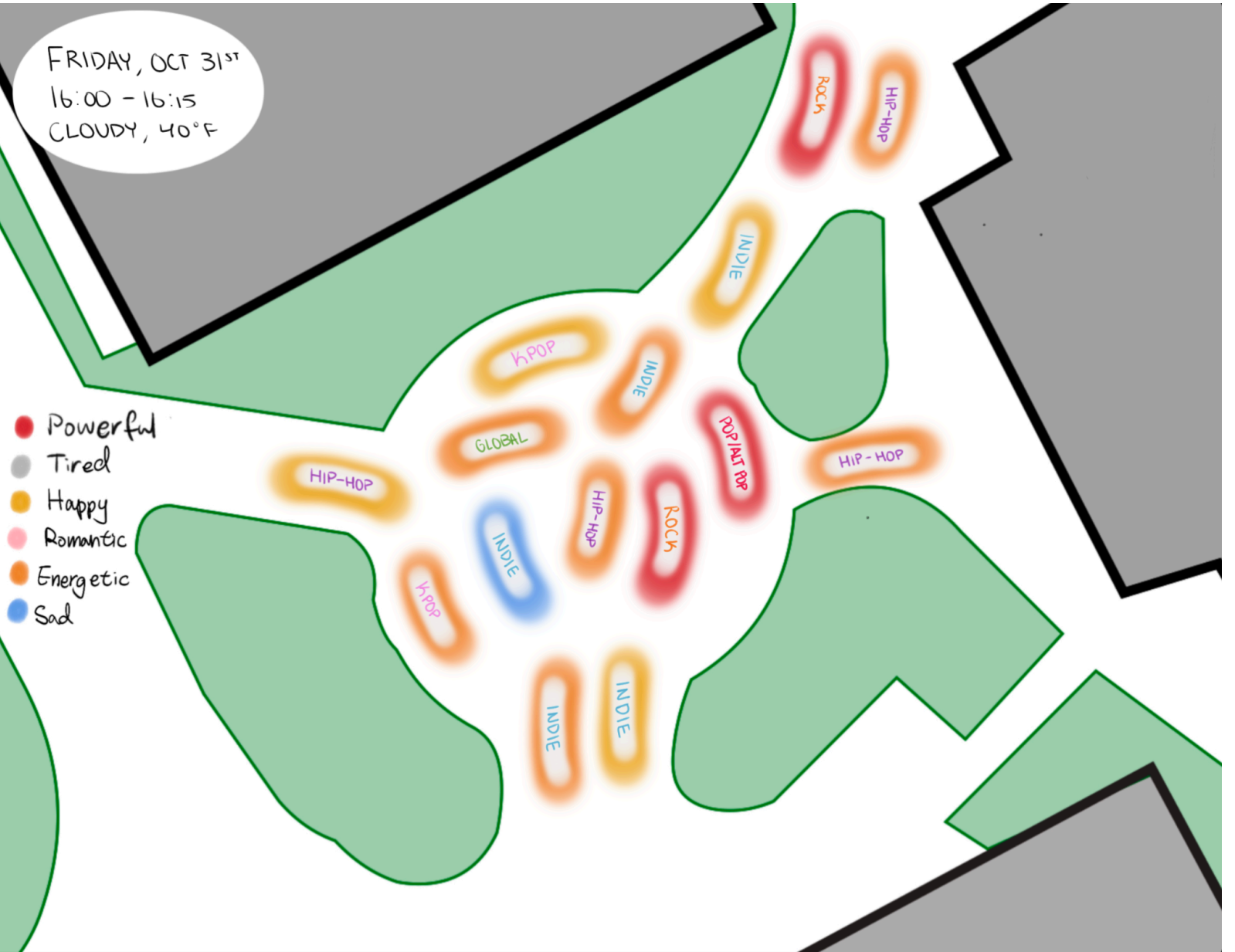
**Sunday November 2, 2025**

**1:00 PM - 1:15 PM**

**Sunny, 59\***

| <b>Name of Song + Artist</b>         | <b>Genre</b>           | <b>Emotion/Feeling</b> |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
| Sex is Powerful - MARINA             | Pop / Alt Pop          | Powerful               |
| Into It - Chase Atlantic             | Pop / Alt Pop          | Tired                  |
| Titi Me Pregunto - Bad Bunny         | Global / International | Happy                  |
| Feel Like A Stranger - Grateful Dead | Indie / Alternative    | Energetic              |
| Past Lives - sapientdream            | Indie / Alternative    | Happy                  |
| Rodrick Rules - Malcolm Todd         | Indie / Alternative    | Happy                  |
| Vaaroon - Anand Bhaskar              | Global / International | Romantic               |
| In my head - Ariana Grande           | Pop / Alt Pop          | Powerful               |
| Pt. 2 - Kanye West                   | Hip-Hop / R&B          | Energetic              |
| Young Dumb and Broke - Khalid        | Pop / Alt Pop          | Happy                  |
| Savior Complex - Phoebe Bridgers     | Indie / Alternative    | Sad                    |
| Ditto - NewJeans                     | K-Pop / Dance Pop      | Happy                  |
| Drama - Aespa                        | K-Pop / Dance Pop      | Energetic              |
| Blue - PinkPantheress                | Indie / Alternative    | Energetic              |
| Location - Playboi Carti             | Hip-Hop / R&B          | Happy                  |

Final Maps



SUNDAY, NOV 2<sup>ND</sup>

13:00 - 13:15

SUNNY, 59°F

- Powerful
- Tired
- Happy
- Romantic
- Energetic
- Sad





## Reflection

*As you record information to create your map, consider the visual design (layout, typography, map key if any required etc.) of your map and the overall experience of looking at, interpreting and using the map. After completing the mapping exercise, reflect on and respond to the below questions (1 paragraph each) as a team.*

### **What did you decide to map and why?**

We decided to map the Snell Library Quad located just outside the Curry Student Center as we realised that it gets the most foot traffic, whether people are commuting between home and campus using the T or visiting the library between classes. We expected this area to be where people would be mostly walking by at busy times of the day. This space offers a natural setting to observe different behaviour. We also figured that when people are walking, they usually listen to music at that time and aren't focused on work or class at that moment as compared to if they were sitting down and working. This could suggest that emotions are more easily identifiable and range across different categories. We specifically focused on the songs people were listening to and their moods/emotions because we wanted to explore the relationship between music and emotion in a public setting.

### **Whose story are you telling with your map and whose story are you not telling?**

The story we are telling are the students of Northeastern and their daily routine based on their mood as expressed through their music choices on contrasting days. We picked two different days (Friday and Sunday) that we thought would have the biggest contrast. Friday (Halloween) is a day to celebrate finishing the week and getting ready for the exciting weekend, while Sunday is focused on resetting for the upcoming week and is considered a day of rest and relaxation. This essentially captures how students' emotional states and music preferences shift between a festive evening and a quiet weekend morning. It also depicts the relationship between specific genres and emotional feelings. The Snell Quad is located on Northeastern University Campus grounds, and so the range of people does not reach the general population, like those going to work, people going to school, etc. It is limited to primarily Northeastern students. This map also excludes people who aren't listening to music or weren't comfortable with sharing their song choices with us.

### **What problems and opportunities does looking at the NU campus/neighborhood/Boston through your map reveal to us?**

Looking at the Northeastern University campus and neighborhood through our map can reveal certain problems relating to students every-day lives highlighting the connection between

mood, music, and time. Every student has their own fixed schedule and routine, and the genre of music they are listening to at different times of the day can demonstrate their emotional and mental state; such as, on a Monday morning the student can feel tired so maybe they will listen to rap music to hype them up and give them more energy for the day. Or if they are feeling a little down and so they listen to a somber tune. Mapping out the Snell Library Quad through music genre and mood can help unveil a pattern in Northeastern campus life and reflect a certain consensus that all students share in their hardships and community. Our map can also indicate how the environment can affect mood by showing how different areas of the Snell Library Quad could inflict different types of music based on a person's surroundings.